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Inventor(s)	Koltz, Jr.; Michael et al.

Surgical gas delivery system and method for gas sealed insufflation and recirculation with UVC sterilization

Abstract

A surgical gas delivery system is disclosed for gas sealed insufflation and recirculation during an endoscopic or laparoscopic surgical procedure, which includes a gaseous sealing manifold for communicating with a gas sealed access port, a compressor for recirculating gas through the gaseous sealing manifold, and a source of UVC irradiation for sterilizing at least the gas recirculating through the gaseous sealing manifold.

Inventors:	Koltz, Jr.; Michael (Aurora, CO), Teymouri; Jonathan (Aurora, CO)
Applicant:	Conmed Corporation (Utica, NY)
Family ID:	1000008781402
Assignee:	Conmed Corporation (Largo, FL)
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Primary Examiner: Bosworth; Kami A

Assistant Examiner: Smale; Avery

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Troutman Pepper Locke LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The subject invention is directed to minimally invasive surgery, and more particularly, to a surgical gas delivery system and method for gas sealed insufflation and recirculation with internal

UVC gas sterilization for use during an endoscopic or laparoscopic surgical procedure.

2. Description of Related Art

(2) Laparoscopic or “minimally invasive” surgical techniques are becoming commonplace in the performance of procedures such as cholecystectomies, appendectomies, hernia repair and nephrectomies. Benefits of such procedures include reduced trauma to the patient, reduced opportunity for infection, and decreased recovery time. Such procedures within the abdominal (peritoneal) cavity are typically performed through a device known as a trocar or cannula, which facilitates the introduction of laparoscopic instruments into the abdominal cavity of a patient.

(3) Additionally, such procedures commonly involve filling or “insufflating” the abdominal cavity with a pressurized fluid, such as carbon dioxide, to create an operating space, which is referred to as a pneumoperitoneum. The insufflation can be carried out by a surgical access device, such as a trocar, equipped to deliver insufflation fluid, or by a separate insufflation device, such as an insufflation (veress) needle. Introduction of surgical instruments into the pneumoperitoneum without a substantial loss of insufflation gas is desirable, in order to maintain the pneumoperitoneum.

(4) During typical laparoscopic procedures, a surgeon makes three to four small incisions, usually no larger than about twelve millimeters each, which are typically made with the surgical access devices themselves, often using a separate inserter or obturator placed therein. Following insertion, the obturator is removed, and the trocar allows access for instruments to be inserted into the abdominal cavity. Typical trocars provide a pathway to insufflate the abdominal cavity, so that the surgeon has an open interior space in which to work.

(5) The trocar must also provide a way to maintain the pressure within the cavity by sealing between the trocar and the surgical instrument being used, while still allowing at least a minimum amount of freedom of movement for the surgical instruments. Such instruments can include, for example, scissors, grasping instruments, and occluding instruments, cauterizing units, cameras, light sources and other surgical instruments. Sealing elements or mechanisms are typically provided on trocars to prevent the escape of insufflation gas from the abdominal cavity. These sealing mechanisms often comprise a duckbill-type valve made of a relatively pliable material, to seal around an outer surface of surgical instruments passing through the trocar.

(6) SurgiQuest, Inc., a wholly owned subsidiary of ConMed Corporation has developed unique gas sealed surgical access devices that permit ready access to an insufflated surgical cavity without the need for conventional mechanical valve seals, as described, for example, in U.S. Pat. Nos.

7,854,724 and 8,795,223. These access devices are constructed from several nested components including an inner tubular body portion and a coaxial outer tubular body portion. The inner tubular body portion defines a gas sealed central lumen for introducing conventional laparoscopic or endoscopic surgical instruments to the surgical cavity of a patient and the outer tubular body portion defines an annular lumen surrounding the inner tubular body portion for delivering insufflation gas to the surgical cavity of the patient and for facilitating periodic sensing of abdominal pressure.

(7) SurgiQuest has also developed multimodal surgical gas delivery systems for use with the unique gas sealed access devices described above. These gas delivery systems, which are disclosed for example in U.S. Pat. Nos. 9,199,047 and 9,375,539 have a first mode of operation for providing gas sealed access to a body cavity, a second mode of operation for performing smoke evacuation from the body cavity, and a third mode of operation for providing insufflation gas to the body cavity.

(8) The efficacy of Ultraviolet light to reduce nosocomial infections in operating rooms, patient rooms and chronic care facilities caused by bacterial, viral and fungal microorganisms is well documented. The reduction of viral loads in blood, serum and other body fluids by way of Ultraviolet light application has also been demonstrated. Studies have also documented reduction of bacterial colonies in open wounds and burn victims using UV light treatment.

(9) To date however, the use of UV light to reduce viral and/or bacterial microorganisms that may be carried by surgical gases delivered to and from a surgical cavity during a laparoscopic or endoscopic surgical procedure has not been demonstrated. It would be beneficial therefore to employ UV light in a surgical gas delivery system to sterilize the gas flow and reduce or otherwise eliminate viral and/or bacterial loads carried in the surgical gases, as well as to sterilize the gas flow passages of the gas delivery device itself.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(10) A new and useful surgical gas delivery system is disclosed for gas sealed insufflation and recirculation during an endoscopic or laparoscopic surgical procedure, which includes a gaseous sealing manifold for communicating with a gas sealed access port, a compressor for recirculating gas through the gaseous sealing manifold, and a source of UVC irradiation for sterilizing at least the gas recirculating through the gaseous sealing manifold.

(11) Preferably, the system further includes an intercooler or condenser that is interposed between the compressor and the gaseous sealing manifold for conditioning gas flowing therethrough. The source of UVC irradiation is positioned within the intercooler or condenser to sterilize internal flow passages thereof and the gas flowing therethrough. The source of UVC irradiation includes at least one light source that is in communication with the internal flow passages of the intercooler or condenser, and which is adapted and configured to generate UVC radiation at a wavelength of about between 240-350 nm. The light source can be either an LED light source or a florescent light source.

(12) The subject invention is also directed to a method of surgical gas delivery during a surgical procedure which includes the steps of recirculating gas through a gas sealed access port to provide gas sealed access to a body cavity and to maintain a stable cavity pressure during the surgical procedure, and sterilizing the gas recirculating through the gas sealed access port by way of UVC irradiation at a wavelength of about between 240-350 nm, wherein the gas recirculating through the gas sealed access port is preferably sterilized at a wavelength of about 265 nm.

(13) These and other features of the gas delivery system and method of the subject invention will become more readily apparent to those having ordinary skill in the art to which the subject invention appertains from the detailed description of the preferred embodiments taken in conjunction with the following brief description of the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) So that those skilled in the art will readily understand how to make and use the gas delivery system and method of the subject invention without undue experimentation, preferred embodiments thereof will be described in detail herein below with reference to the FIGURES wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of the multi-modal gas delivery system of the subject invention, which includes a gaseous sealing manifold for communicating with a gas sealed access port and an insufflation manifold for communicating with the gas sealed access port and with a valve sealed access port, wherein the gas delivery system includes a condenser or intercooler that has an internal source of UVC irradiation for sterilizing internal flow passages thereof and the gas flowing therethrough.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(3) Referring now to the drawings wherein like reference numerals identify similar structural elements and features of the subject invention, there is illustrated in FIG. 1 a new and useful multi-modal surgical gas delivery system **10** that is adapted and configured for gas sealed insufflation, recirculation and smoke evacuation during an endoscopic or laparoscopic surgical procedure. The

multi-modal surgical gas delivery system **10** of the subject invention includes a gaseous sealing manifold **110** for communicating with a gas sealed access port **20** and an insufflation manifold **210** for communicating with the gas sealed access port **20** and with a valve sealed access port **30**.

(4) The gas sealed access port **20** is of the type disclosed in commonly assigned U.S. Pat. No. 8,795,223, which is incorporated herein by reference. The gas sealed access port **20** is adapted and configured to provide gas sealed instrument access to a body cavity, while maintaining a stable pressure within the body cavity (e.g., a stable pneumoperitoneum in the peritoneal or abdominal cavity). In contrast, the valve sealed access port **30** is a conventional or standard trocar, for providing access to a body cavity through a mechanical valve seal, such as, for example, a duckbill seal, septum seal or the like. Depending upon the requirements of a particular surgical procedure, the multi-modal gas delivery system **10** can be utilized with either the gas sealed access port **20**, the valve sealed access port **30** or with both access ports **20**, **30** at the same time.

(5) The gas delivery system **10** further includes a compressor or positive pressure pump **40** for recirculating surgical gas through the gas sealed access port **20** by way of the gaseous sealing manifold **110**. The compressor **40** is preferably driven by a brushless DC (direct-current) motor, which can be advantageously controlled to adjust gas pressure and flow rates within the gas delivery system **10**, as disclosed for example in commonly assigned U.S. Pat. No. 10,702,306, which is incorporated herein by reference. Alternatively, the compressor **40** can be driven by an AC motor, but a DC motor will be relatively smaller and lighter, and therefore more advantageous from a manufacturing standpoint.

(6) An intercooler and/or condenser **50** is operatively associated with the compressor **40** for cooling or otherwise conditioning gas recirculating through the gaseous sealing manifold **110**. A UVC irradiator **52** is operatively associated with the intercooler or condenser **50** for sterilizing gas recirculating through the internal flow passages **54** formed therein by way of the compressor **40**. In addition, the UVC irradiator is intended to sterilize the interior surfaces of the gas conduits or flow passages through which the gas flows within the intercooler/condenser **50**.

(7) The UVC irradiator **52** preferably includes at least one LED light source or a florescent light source that is adapted and configured to generate UVC radiation at a wavelength of about between 240-350 nm, and preferably about 265 nm. This ultraviolet light at such a wavelength can sterilize viral, bacterial and microbial bodies within the gas conduits of the system, and can reduce coronavirus including SARS-COV-2.

(8) Preferably, compressor **40**, intercooler/condenser **50**, gaseous sealing manifold **110** and insufflation manifold **210** are all enclosed within a common housing, which includes a graphical user interface and control electronics, as disclosed for example in commonly assigned U.S. Pat. No. 9,199,047, which is incorporated herein by reference.

(9) The gas delivery system **10** further includes a surgical gas source **60** that communicates with the gaseous sealing manifold **110** and the insufflation manifold **210**. The gas source **60** can be a local pressure vessel or a remote supply tank associated with a hospital or healthcare facility. Preferably, gas from the surgical gas source **60** flows through a high pressure regulator **65** and a gas heater **70** before it is delivered to the gaseous sealing manifold **110** and the insufflation manifold **210**. Preferably, the high pressure regulator **65** and the gas heater **70** are also enclosed with the compressor **40**, intercooler **50**, gaseous sealing manifold **110** and insufflation manifold **210** in the common housing.

(10) The gas delivery system **10** further includes a first outlet line valve (OLV1) **212** that is operatively associated with the insufflation manifold **210** for controlling a flow of insufflation gas to the valve sealed access port **30** and a second outlet line valve (OLV2) **214** that is operatively associated with the insufflation manifold **210** for controlling a flow of insufflation gas to the gas sealed access port **20**.

(11) In accordance with a preferred embodiment of the subject invention, the first and second outlet line valves **212**, **214** of insufflation manifold **210** are proportional valves that are configured to

dynamically alter or otherwise control the outflow of insufflation gas to the access ports **20**, **30** to match volume fluctuations that may arise in a patient's body cavity as they occur. The first and second proportional outlet line valves **212**, **214** provide the gas delivery system **10** with fine control of insufflation gas flow rate to achieve stable flow rates at lower pressure, reduce pressure oscillation and eliminate pneumatic hammer.

(12) Because the first and second proportional outlet line valves **212**, **214** are proximal to the patient where flow friction losses are relatively low, the gas delivery system **10** is able to measure peritoneal pressures accurately. Moreover, the use of proportional outlet line valves for this purpose is uniquely possible here, because there is constant gas recirculation throughout the gas delivery system **10**, either by way of closed loop smoke evacuation or by way of the gas sealed access port **20**.

(13) Proportional valves allow for infinitely variable gas flow adjustment between a minimum flow state and a maximum flow state. Given that some volume changes in a patient's body cavity, such as breathing, are expected and consistent, by employing proportional outlet line valves, the insufflation manifold **210** is able to dynamically alter the gas flow to the body cavity to inverse the expected volume changes, resulting in a neutral effect on the pressure inside the cavity.

(14) An additional benefit of using proportional valves for controlling the outflow of insufflation gas from manifold **210** is a reduction in response time, as compared to that of a solenoid valve. A solenoid valve operates by applying energy to coils, which produces an electromagnetic force that moves a piston. However, the energizing of the coils takes some amount of time, introducing a delay between a commanded action and the physical movement of the piston. In contrast, proportional valves, as employed in the gas delivery system **10** of the subject invention, do not have an energization delay in general, and so they have an improved response time as compared to solenoid valves.

(15) The insufflation manifold **210** further includes a first patient pressure sensor (PWS1) **222** downstream from the first outlet line valve **212** and a second patient pressure sensor (PWS1) **224** downstream from the second outlet line valve **214**. These two patient pressure sensors are used to measure abdominal pressure to control outlet line valves **212**, **214**, respectively. Two other pressure sensors are located upstream from the outlet line valves **212**, **214**, and are labeled as DPS1 and DPS2. These two pressure sensors are situated within a venturi to measure a pressure differential that is used to infer a total gas flow rate from the insufflation manifold **210** to the patient's body cavity.

(16) A primary proportional valve (PRV) **216** is also operatively associated with insufflation manifold **210** and it is located upstream from the first and second outlet line valves **212**, **214** to control the flow of insufflation gas to the first and second outlet line valves **212**, **214**. Proportional valve **216** functions to maintain an intermediate pressure within the insufflation manifold **210** (as the central node in the LPU) at a constant pressure between 1 and 80 mmHg, dependent on the system operating mode. The opening of PRV **216** can be indirectly initiated by any of the following actions: patient respiration, gas leakage downstream of PRV **216**, or the opening of the safety valve LSV **227** or ventilation valve VEV **228**, i.e. any event that causes an intermediate pressure to drop. In the system. LSV **227** and VEV **228** are described in more detail below.

(17) The gaseous sealing manifold **110** also includes a high pressure gas fill valve (GFV) **112** that is operatively associated with an outlet side of the compressor **40**. GFV **112** is adapted and configured to control gas delivered into the gaseous sealing manifold **110** from the source of surgical gas **60**. Preferably, the gas fill valve **112** is a proportional valve that is able to dynamically control surgical gas delivered into the gaseous sealing manifold **110**.

(18) The gaseous sealing manifold **110** also includes a smoke evacuation valve (SEV) **114** that is operatively associated with an outlet side of the compressor **40** for dynamically controlling gas flow between the gaseous sealing manifold **110** and the insufflation manifold **210** under certain operating conditions, such as, for example, when the gas delivery device **10** is operating in a smoke

evacuation mode. Preferably, the smoke evacuation valve **114** is a proportional valve.

(19) A bypass valve (SPV) **116** is positioned between an outlet side of the compressor **40** and an inlet side of the compressor **40** for controlling gas flow within the gaseous sealing manifold **110** under certain operating conditions. Preferably, the bypass valve **116** is a proportional valve, which is variably opened to establish and control the gaseous seal generated within gas sealed access port **20**. Moreover, bypass valve **116** controls gas flow rate to the gaseous seal using feedback from pressure sensors **122**, **124**, described in further detail below.

(20) The gaseous sealing manifold **110** also includes an air ventilation valve (AVV) **118**, which is operatively associated with an inlet side of the compressor **40** for controlling the entrainment of atmospheric air into the system **10** under certain operating conditions. For example, AVV **118** will permit the introduction of atmospheric air into the gaseous sealing circuit to increase the air mass (i.e., the standard volume) within the circuit. The thermodynamics of clinical use conditions can cause a loss of standard volume within the gas circuit. The ventilation valve **118** permits the gas delivery system **10** to make up for this lost volume, in order to ensure that pump pressure and flow rates are sufficient to maintain the gaseous seal within the gas sealed access port **20**. The ventilation valve **118** can also be opened to reduce the vacuum side pressure in the gas seal circuit.

(21) An overpressure relief valve (ORV) **120** is operatively associated with an outlet side of the compressor **40** for controlling a release of gas from the system **10** to atmosphere under certain operating conditions. Preferably, the overpressure relief valve **120** is a proportional valve that is opened to reduce the positively pressurized side of the gas seal circuit, especially in the event of an emergency, such as a loss of power to the gas delivery system **10**. The normally open configuration of relief valve **120** reduces the risk of over-pressurization of the patient cavity upon loss of power to that valve.

(22) A first pressure sensor (RLS) **122** is operatively associated with an inlet side of the compressor **40** and a second pressure sensor (PLS) **124** is operatively associated with an outlet side of the compressor **40**. These pressure sensors **122**, **124** are situated to have unobstructed and minimally restricted communication with the patient's abdominal cavity in order to continuously and accurately measure cavity pressure. The signals from these two pressure sensors **122**, **124** are employed by a controller of the gas delivery system **10** to modulate the opening of the two outlet line valves **212** and **214**, to control the patient cavity pressure.

(23) In addition, the gaseous sealing manifold **110** includes a gas quality sensor **126** that is operatively associated with an outlet side of the compressor **40**. The gas quality sensor monitors the level of oxygen in the recirculation circuit, which corresponds to a concentration of CO.sub.2 in the body cavity of a patient, as disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 9,199,047.

(24) A first blocking valve (BV1) **132** is operatively associated with an outlet flow path of the gaseous sealing manifold **110** and a second blocking valve (BV2) **134** is operatively associated with an inlet flow path to the gaseous sealing manifold **110**. The blocking valves **132**, **134** are employed during a self-test prior to a surgical procedure, as disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 9,199,047. It is envisioned that the first and second blocking valves **132**, **134** could be mechanically actuated or pneumatically actuated.

(25) A first filter element **142** is positioned downstream from the first blocking valve **132** for filtering pressurized gas flowing from the compressor **40** to the gas sealed access port **20**, and a second filter element **144** is positioned upstream from the second first blocking valve **134** for filtering gas returning to the compressor **40** from the gas sealed access port **20**. Preferably, the filter elements **142**, **144** are housed within a common filter cartridge, as disclosed for example in U.S. Pat. No. 9,199,047.

(26) The first and second blocking valves **132**, **134** communicate with a blocking valve pilot (BVP) **226** that is included within the insufflation manifold **210**. Preferably, the blocking valve pilot **226** is a solenoid valve. It is envisioned that BVP **226** could be fed from the compressor outlet as shown or from a gas source such as surgical gas or air. The insufflation manifold **110** further

includes a pressure sensor (PMS) **225** located downstream from the primary proportional valve **216** and upstream from the outlet line valves **212**, **214**. The two outlet line valves are opened to introduce insufflation gas to the patient's body cavity by way of the access ports **23**, **30**. This introduction of gas has the effect of increasing pressure within the body cavity. Additionally, the outlet line valves **212**, **214** can be opened in conjunction with air ventilation valve **228** to release gas from the body cavity, having the effect of desufflation and reduction of cavity pressure.

(27) The insufflation manifold **210** further includes a low pressure safety valve (LSV) **227** downstream from the primary proportional valve **216** and upstream from the first and second outlet line valves **212**, **214** for controlling a release of gas from the system **10** to atmosphere under certain operating conditions. LSV **227** is a purely mechanical valve that functions to limit the maximum intermediate pressure within the manifold **210** or LPU (Low Pressure Unit) in the event of a power interruption, a pressure controller malfunction or if a valve located upstream from the LSV sticks in an open position.

(28) In addition, a ventilation exhaust valve (VEV) **228** is positioned downstream from the primary proportional valve **216** and upstream from the outlet line valves **212**, **214** for controlling a release of gas from the system **10** to atmosphere under certain operating conditions. The ventilation exhaust valve **228** is preferably a proportional valve that is opened to desufflate or otherwise reduce patient cavity pressure. Additionally, VEV **228** can be opened to reduce intermediate pressure within the LPU.

(29) A filter element **242** is positioned downstream from the first outlet line valve **212** for filtering insufflation gas flowing from the insufflation manifold **210** to the valve sealed access port **30**. Another filter element **244** is positioned downstream from the second outlet line valve **224** for filtering insulation gas flowing from the insufflation manifold **210** to the gas sealed access port **20**. Preferably, filter element **244** is housed with filter elements **142** and **144** in a common filter cartridge, while filter element **242** is separately located.

(30) While the gas delivery system of the subject disclosure has been shown and described with reference to preferred embodiments, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that changes and/or modifications may be made thereto without departing from the scope of the subject disclosure.

Claims

1. A surgical gas delivery system for gas sealed insufflation and recirculation comprising: a) a gaseous sealing manifold for communicating with a gas sealed access port; b) a compressor for recirculating gas through the gaseous sealing manifold; c) an intercooler or a condenser interposed between the compressor and the gaseous sealing manifold for conditioning the gas recirculating through the intercooler or the condenser, wherein the gas recirculating through the intercooler or the condenser passes through the intercooler or the condenser twice, once before entering the compressor and then again after exiting the compressor, wherein: the gas flows directly from an outlet of the gaseous sealing module to a first inlet of the intercooler or the condenser, and then directly from a first outlet of the intercooler or the condenser to an inlet of the compressor during a first pass through the intercooler or the condenser, and the gas then flows directly from an outlet of the compressor to a second inlet of the intercooler or the condenser, and then directly from a second outlet of the intercooler or the condenser to an inlet of the gaseous sealing module during a second pass through the intercooler or the condenser; and d) a source of UV irradiation located within the intercooler or the condenser for sterilizing the gas recirculating through the intercooler or the condenser during the first pass and during the second pass.
2. The system recited in claim 1, wherein the source of UV irradiation includes at least one light source that is adapted and configured to generate UV radiation at a wavelength of about between 240-350 nm.

3. The system recited in claim 2, wherein the at least one light source is an LED light source or a florescent light source.
 4. The system recited in claim 1, wherein a source of surgical gas communicates with the gaseous sealing manifold.
 5. The system recited in claim 4, further comprising an insufflation manifold for communicating with the gas sealed access port, and wherein the insufflation manifold communicates with the source of surgical gas.
 6. The system recited in claim 5, wherein the insufflation manifold is adapted and configured to communicate with the gas sealed access port and with a valve sealed access port.
 7. The system recited in claim 5, wherein gas from the source of surgical gas flows through a high pressure regulator and a gas heater before the gas is delivered to the gaseous sealing manifold and the insufflation manifold.
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